

Dear Admission Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR SAMUEL OTIENO GARIY, PF 31672

Samuel is a scholar in the *Equity Leadership Programme (ELP)* under Equity Bank Limited. The ELP programme admits the best performers nationally in the Kenya Certificate for Secondary Education examinations and through internship and mentorship offers them the prerequisite skills for career success. And for the last eight months, Samuel has worked exceptionally well under my supervision as an intern at Equity Bank, Ruiru Branch.

Samuel joined the branch in January. He was a neat young man whose amiable nature quickly made him a favorite among the existing staff. He first worked in the Mobile Banking department where he was put in charge of customer registration and dealing with customer complaints. This was a task he undertook with diligence and with the general ease of a more experienced member of staff despite being new to the business. His high work rate heavily reduced the workload of his supervisor in the department. This efficiency meant some days they would close business even two hours earlier than the usual time prior to his arrival.

In addition, Samuel possessed an aptitude for learning this coupled with his strong work ethic and flexibility made him a key member of the branch. For instance, in February after a staff member transferred a vacancy opened up at the Bank's reception desk. Being short-staffed at that moment and a replacement not forthcoming, I was forced to transfer Samuel to the department. This was in spite of my reservations due to the fact that the desk was very sensitive and involved a lot of pressure especially from complaining customers and as such requiring a lot of care and preferably a more experienced member of staff. Samuel nonetheless, dispelled my fears as soon as he moved to the reception where he was now in charge with no supervisor. His charisma and ingenuity when dealing with customers made sure that all customers left the bank satisfied. Furthermore, his unmatched energy when carrying out his duties was such that the customer hardly had to queue before being served. This raised our Branch's ratings in customer service and during this period we received many positive reviews on social media platforms.

As a member of staff, Samuel always maintained the highest standards with regards to accountability, transparency, and professionalism. This was a bar he set high even later when he was put in charge of Cheque clearing, local and international money transfers and custodial issues pertaining to buying and selling of shares as the Branch's clearing officer. Samuel's willingness to go far and beyond the customers' expectations when giving service made him a favorite for some customers as well. Some of whom funny enough wait in line just to be served by him!

Samuel also went far and beyond the call of duty. He was always ready to lend a helping hand to his fellow colleagues. He was always ready to step in for colleagues who could not make it work and performed their duties wholeheartedly. In fact, he used to serve a teller in the bank's retail section during peak hours after which he would still go back to his desk and finish his duties. His creativity and adeptness to technology and computers made him our in-house technical expert. He fixed our printers and computers when they broke down and always came up with new ideas to solve connectivity issues. It is this team spirit that he displays that made him employee of the month for four months in a row.

In part of Equity's approach to maintain organization culture the *Inter-Branch Culture Competitions*. Samuel led the bass part of the Ruiru branch choir. His enthusiasm for the event was infectious and

brought the team together. Together, we emerged the best choir in the Nairobi region. Samuel's punctuality was also noteworthy. He consistently came earlier than the rest of the branch and at times left way past the working hours. This did not water down his spirit as he continued to serve with the same passion throughout.

Out of all the interns I have worked with, Samuel truly stands out. He left a long-lasting impact and it was difficult to see him go. With this in mind, I have no doubt he will be a great addition to your school.

Yours faithfully,



Elijah Maina,

Relationship Manager Operations,

Equity Bank, Ruiru Branch.